

# Leonard Eckert

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## PROFILE

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Data-driven computer scientist with hands-on experience across data engineering, NLP, and cloud platforms, gained through eight international internships with IBM Research and IBM Client Engineering as well as a role as a Data Engineer at Bosch Research. Combines a strong software-development foundation from an apprenticeship at DESY with applied AI research from a Bachelor's thesis on a semantic alignment agent for natural language generation. Currently pursuing a Master's degree in AI and Linguistics at Stockholm University, with a continued interest in building intelligent, data-driven systems.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Languages & Frameworks:** Java, Python, C, SQL, R, Spring Boot, React.js, LangChain

**Cloud & Tools:** Databricks, Apache Spark, Azure, Bicep, OpenShift, Docker, Git, Linux, Neo4j, GraphQL, Kafka

## EDUCATION

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### Stockholm University

Stockholm, Sweden

*Master of Science, AI and Linguistics*

*Aug. 2026 – Aug. 2028*

- Coursework spans computational linguistics, machine learning, and language technology
- Builds on Bachelor's thesis work on NLP agents and semantic alignment for natural language generation

### DHBW Stuttgart

Stuttgart, Germany

*Bachelor of Science, Business Information Systems (Data Science)*

*Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2025*

- Dual/cooperative study program: alternated academic terms with practical placements at IBM
- Thesis: Design and Implementation of a Semantic Alignment Agent for Natural Language Generation (1.4 German GPA, top 10% of the year)

### Karlstad University

Karlstad, Sweden

*Exchange Semester*

*Jan. 2024 – June 2024*

### Deutsches Elektronen-Synchrotron (DESY)

Hamburg, Germany

*IHK-Certified Vocational Apprenticeship, Computer Science Expert (Software Development)*

*Sep. 2019 – July 2022*

- Dual vocational training combining vocational-school coursework with on-the-job work as a Junior Java Developer at this physics research institute
- Development of a distributed file system for scientific data, dCache, in Java
- Exams passed with excellent grades (93%), top 5% of the year

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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### Data Engineer

Sep. 2025 – Now

*Bosch Research*

*Stuttgart, Germany*

- Developed and maintained a Databricks data pipeline written in Python
- Built a high-performance Apache Spark application processing over 30 billion records while reliably parsing MF4 files
- Supported the infrastructure team with platform development in MS Azure using Bicep

### QA Engineer (Fulltime Role)

Apr. 2019 – Aug. 2019

*Unitymedia via Prodapt Solutions Pvt. Ltd.*

*Cologne, Germany*

- Created a resource planning tool with Excel and VBA
- Test execution and test planning for a B2B platform
- Testing internal tools with IBM AS400

## INTERNSHIPS

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### IBM Client Engineering

*Intern – Vienna, Austria*

*June 2025 – Sep. 2025*

- Developed an innovative agent-based demo using WatsonX Orchestrate for partner enablement
- Performed advanced data analysis using Python to process and extract insights from complex datasets

*Intern – Singapore*

*Sep. 2024 – Nov. 2024*

- Built and deployed a containerized application on OpenShift to analyze JVM garbage collector memory allocation in Java
- Created presentation materials for client-facing workshops

*Intern – Stuttgart Ehningen, Germany*

*Dec. 2022 – Mar. 2023*

- Built multiple prototypes for Watson OpenScale to monitor LLM performance on IBM Cloud Pak for Data
- Deployed a demo cluster on OpenShift in a successful client engagement
- Collaborated with an offshore team in India to troubleshoot and resolve issues

### IBM Research

*Research Intern – Dublin, Ireland*

*Feb. 2025 – May 2025*

- High focus on development of the NLP agent for my Bachelor thesis
- Developed a custom LangChain component integrating LLaMA, DeepSeek, and Granite models into a unified interface

*Research Intern – Dublin, Ireland*

*June 2024 – Sep. 2024*

- Designed and implemented a smart evaluation framework for Large Language Models, focusing on tailored performance metrics in Python
- Containerized and deployed the application for scalable and reproducible execution

*Research Intern – Zürich Rüschlikon, Switzerland*

*June 2023 – Sep. 2023*

- Implemented a custom schema for polymorphic GraphQL in Java
- Built a small demo in Neo4j to model and visualize a knowledge graph
- Modified an existing Kafka consumer to improve data processing efficiency

### IBM Consulting

*Intern*

*Wilhelmshaven, Germany*

*Nov. 2023 – Jan. 2024*

- Contributed to a SASPF (SAP Bundeswehr solution) project for the German Navy
- Supported a project to improve material readiness and availability

### Testbirds GmbH

*Project Management Intern*

*Munich, Germany*

*Oct. 2018 – Mar. 2019*

- Completed crowd test evaluation, including a presentation of the results to clients
- Template development in Excel and with Power BI and R

## SELECTED PROJECTS

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### Hippo Codes

*2024 – present*

- Full-stack development of a game addressing the consequences of climate change
- Sole developer responsible for the complete implementation, including the CI/CD pipeline – [hippo-codes.com](https://hippo-codes.com)

### Semantix

*Nov. 2024 – Feb. 2025*

- Built a German word-guessing minigame leveraging word embeddings with vector search powered by Pinecone
- Deployed using Vercel – [semantix-green.vercel.app](https://semantix-green.vercel.app)

### EveryOneCounts.de *(Founded after a hackathon against the covid pandemic)*

*Mar. 2020 – Aug. 2020*

- Visualized social distancing in the corona pandemic using multiple data sources
- Project went viral and I talked about it in the media – [Tagesschau](#) feature
- Developed a prototype to count customers in public spaces using 3D printing and an ESP32 in C

## LANGUAGES

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German – native speaker, English – business fluent, Swedish – beginner

## ADDITIONAL

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**Volunteering:** Working as a trained paramedic at events (03/2016 – 02/2020)

**Interests:** Machine learning, 3D printing, economics, photography, flight simulation, skiing

**Driver's license:** German driver's license Class B (Cars)